

» T20 WORLD CUP BUMPER GROUP B



Tournament opener: Australia begins its World Cup campaign on February 11 against Ireland, with all group matches in Sri Lanka. AFP

Chasers and chances

Australia and Sri Lanka enter the competition in pursuit of redemption, while Zimbabwe, Ireland and Oman hover on the margins, **searching for a narrow path** to an upset.

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Group B of the 2026 T20 World Cup brings together two teams that fell short in the previous edition. Sri Lanka, co-host of the upcoming event, failed to qualify for the Super Eight stage, finishing behind South Africa and Bangladesh in its group. Australia,

the No. 2-ranked men's T20I team in the world, lost to Afghanistan in the final-eight stage in the West Indies, ending its chances of reaching the semifinal. Both teams have chosen to retain most of their 2024 squads rather than make wholesale personnel changes. Sri Lanka has opted for a change in leadership,

with Dasun Shanaka taking over from Charith Asalanka. Mitchell Marsh will continue to lead the Aussies.

Australia has won 17 of its 24 T20Is since 2024. The only series loss came at home against India, the defending champion. Skipper Marsh has led from the front with the bat,